Do You Know?

In 1974, Herman Hertzberger created the Central Beheer insurance company, a space conceived as a "village worker" designed so that the occupants 'would have the feeling of being part of a working community without being lost in the crowd'. The space was deliberately flexible and consisted of small workspaces, like the islands forming virtually to connect to one another. These structured platforms were built repeatedly throughout the space and can accommodate groups of ten people, who were encouraged to decorate their workspace themselves, including adding their own furniture.

Administrative Manager, Commercial Manager, etc.

Today, in the modern era of dynamic and competitive business environment, the office manager has to perform a wide variety of tasks from managing basic office services to handling of the most modern techniques of systems integration, automation, operations research and communication. In performing these tasks he assumes the position of a full-fledged functional executive at par with other operational executives.

1.6.1. Qualifications of Office Manager:

The qualifications of a successful office manager are grouped under the following three heads (i) Education and Practical training, (ii) Experience and (iii) Personal qualities.

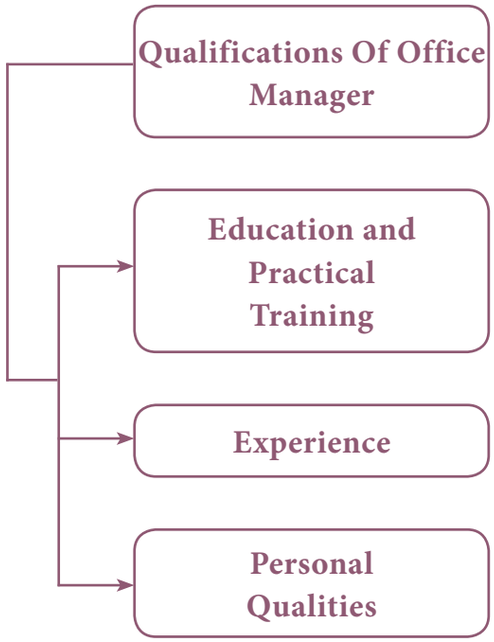


Fig. 1. 9. Qualifications of Office Manager

(i) **Education and Practical training:** An office manager must have appropriate educational qualifications. He should possess not only bachelor's degree in the relevant discipline, but also have proficiency in English and one or more foreign languages. The office manager must also have special training in business administration, accounting, office systems and procedures, office machines and data processing methods.

(ii) **Experience:** He should have sufficient business experience preferably be in a similar organization as the one employing him as office manager. This will enable the office manager to get familiar with the routine procedures of the organization and also the problems of the office that he has to manage.

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